redirected their heavy artillery fire onto the Gorkhas. Half an hour later, as the shells stopped screaming in, the Chinese infantry launched their attack. In the grey light of dawn, Subedar Kharak Bahadur's forward platoon had held its fire till the Chinese closed in, after which they picked off advancing targets with deadly precision. The Chinese regrouped and launched a second attack at 7.30. When the second attack was also beaten back, they changed tactics and tried to outflank the company. Seeing this, Naik Keshar Bahadur Gurung picked up his Bren and moved to a vantage point from where he kept engaging the enemy. Four waves of the Chinese were repulsed, but each time the survivors would go to ground and the next wave would get in even closer.

The company commander, Captain K. N. Bavadam, could not contact the Battalion or Brigade HQ. So he decided to break through the Chinese cordon on his own and fall back on Maha Plateau. As the withdrawal proceeded, the company was ambushed and outnumbered by Chinese units that had slipped in around them. Naik Keshar Bahadur Gurung was hit on the hip but continued to fight till another round tore into his neck. He was mortally wounded. Havildar Chandra Bahadur Pun took over the Bren and provided covering fire till the last man was able to pull back. Unfortunately he was killed. By then, the Chinese were firing at the withdrawing troops from the abandoned positions on Lachhman Ridge. During the withdrawal, most of the surviving personnel were killed, and Bavadam was captured.

The Chinese attack at 5 a.m. on Maha Plateau had coincided with the assault on the neighbouring 3/3 GR positions on Lachhman Ridge. Charlie Company of 4 Sikh under Major Sandhu fought furiously, taking a heavy toll on the advancing Chinese. Their own casualties, however, were also substantial. Sandhu appealed to Major Harbans Singh, who was commanding Bravo Company at Mithun, for reinforcements. Even though the Chinese had managed to infiltrate the area between Maha Plateau and Mithun and were harassing Harbans's position, a section was immediately dispatched. By the time these men made their way across to Maha Plateau, the survivors from Alpha Company had also reached there. At 7 a. m., the Chinese launched their second attack, and Sandhu was soon overpowered. More than half the Sikhs from Charlie Company at Maha Plateau were either killed or wounded. The few that survived made their way to Mithun where they joined Bravo Company.